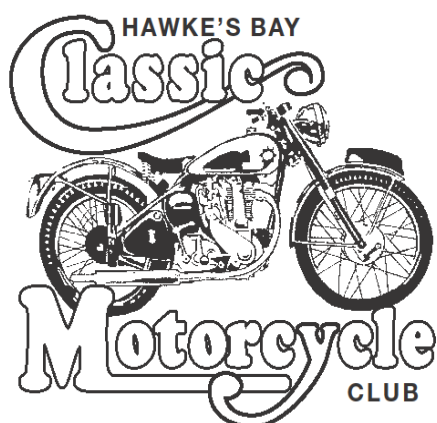


OCTOBER 2026



THE OFFICIAL MAGAZINE OF THE HAWKE'S BAY CLASSIC MOTORCYCLE CLUB INC.

*DEDICATED TO THE USE AND PRESERVATION OF
CLASSIC MOTORCYCLES*

THE CLASSIC BODGER



A beauty arrived at our club bike park during the month of August. A 1948 Triumph Speed Twin, with only 222 miles on its clock, all fresh from a complete restoration by Ken Miles. It started and ran as beautifully as it looked. We look forward to seeing it and his other bikes on many more occasions

Mailing Address:- PO Box 2417, Hastings, 4156

Club Rooms:- Mangaroa Road, Hastings. (Opposite the Cemetery)

A FEARSOME BEAST FROM BAVARIA



SOME BRITISH MILITARY
SIDE VALVE MADNESS
ANOTHER POST WAR
BIKE BEAUTY FROM THE
SHED OF KEN MILES



A BIT OF TOURING COMFORT TOO SIR? GLEN WHITE BROUGHT HIS
THUNDERBIRD TO ADD TO THE LINE UP

PRESIDENTIAL PRATTLE.....

Spring has sprung, and by the time you read this, the rally will be done and dusted. Thank you to everyone who stepped up and helped, whether in a big or small way—your support was truly appreciated. Thank you also to everyone who came along. I hope you had a great time, enjoyed catching up with past rally participants, and had the chance to meet some new faces too. A huge thank you goes to our sponsors: Chemz, Motorcycle Outfitters, Coldrite, Hastings Honda, and Century Yuasa Batteries. Please show your appreciation by supporting their businesses whenever you can.

As the weather gets warmer, more bikes will start making their way out of the dark corners of the shed where they have been hunkering down—and that can only be a good thing. The Kickstart and Retro Ride at the beginning of each month is a great option for older bikes, with Roger providing shorter routes for anyone who prefers something a little gentler than the longer, faster rides later in the month. So, if you have a bike that has not been out for a while, give the battery a charge, pump up the tyres, swing a leg over, and head to Clive BP for a 1.00 pm meet-up and a 1.30 pm departure.

Remember, everyone is welcome on the end-of-month ride. It is a great way for other riders to discover what we are all about and, hopefully, join the club. Quite often someone joins without a classic in the shed, but after a bit of time around the clubrooms, something rubs off — and before long, one bike becomes two.

Totally off topic, but curiosity got the better of me one day this week. I work in central Hastings and have done so for four years, but this week I saw something I had never seen before. There was a line of people forming outside the door to Hastings Farmers—and, even stranger, it was a line of men. Everyone in the office came over for a look and offered up an amazing range of possibilities before I decided I had to know. I approached a couple of the men and asked what I might be missing out on. Their first replies of a hair straightener and an air fryer were not particularly convincing, and eventually they admitted they were there for the 30-year anniversary release of Pokémon cards. Collecting motorcycles no longer seems like such a strange affliction.



See you at the club or out on a ride.

Adelle

Disclaimer: Sometimes we may get something wrong, or breach copyright, (very wrong), but we try to be accurate. We also try not to tell too many lies, but that makes things a little boring sometimes. If we offend, upset, or cause great emotional damage, we are truly sorry, really. Most of this stuff is from just a few demented minds, well one mostly, and it may not be representative of what the Hawke's Bay Classic Motorcycle Club Inc is really about, but they put up with it all, being good sorts and all that.

EDITORIAL RAMBLING.....

So here we go, this is where your Editor sets out where never before has he ventured. This issue is being brought to you by the unkind actions of Microsoft Word. It is very much a case of trying to teach old dogs new tricks and even old tricky dogs are having their moments, as I sought help from one of our club's 'Word' gurus. Whilst the writing of things is reasonably straight forward, it is the things such as adding in a photo and attempting to wrap the text around it that are proving to be a rather large thorn in the editorial side. Some would label these things as 'Progress', I would tend to disagree, but it is the way of things, so we must adapt. Eventually, as with all things, the issue is overcome, but not without moments of angst.



The shed at the Editorial Manse has been hard at work this last week as some serious fettling of a certain new toy has been undertaken. Heated grips and handguards, together with a new front wind deflector, (*I hesitate to call it a screen*). All fluids changed and the radar detector has been fitted via a very nice bit of kit from 'Nicecnc' an Aussie outfit. I retained the panniers from the 09 and with some very simple design work, have made a couple of brackets to allow them to fit on the new baby. Some fancy brake pads made a huge difference to the braking performance. I was rather gob-smacked at how much better they are from the original standard ones, well worth the expense. (*EBC, Sintered HH*). Also, a change of the front direction indicators, (*I am sick of refitting the originals, as they fall out with the merest touch, it stops them breaking, but.....*).

Then a totally left field project arrived, as two well seized up fishing rods and reels were bequeathed to me. My young step Grandson is mad keen on fishing, so he will end up with a couple more objects to fill one corner of his bedroom and annoy his mother as she attempts to keep some sort of order in young Tommy's room. One of the reels took some considerable time to strip down as salt and diecast metal are not the best bedfellows. The end of one rod had been the victim of a car door, or some such bully, so a new tip eyelet was fitted by a clever chap at the local emporium of all things fishy, but eventually all was done and things are working once more. Purchasing some bits and pieces to complete the task made me realise that motorcycling is not the only way to spend large sums of money! Buying fish from a fishmonger today, maybe considered a bit of a 'cheat' in the Huntin', Shootin', Fishin', world, but it is a hell of a lot cheaper.

The post man, or to be more correct a smiling Indian courier driver, arrived the other day with a parcel of wonderment from the Dis-United States of America. A very fancy integrated taillight for, yes, you guessed it, my new love. There is a little button which can change the way all is displayed, so I can now strobe my way around corners at an intersection, I can flash at people when I plan to stop, the

world is just so exciting in the modern day.

I never cease to be impressed and amazed at the level of design sophistication modern bikes now exhibit. The way things all click together, the under-seat side panels locate onto the taillight assy, the radiator guards locate the indicators. Everything seems to perform several functions. All the connectors are located by clips in just the right place. There must be an anthill army of little design engineers sitting at screens figuring out how to best fit this so it can best fit that, and then the whole lot is held together by plastic trim clips, which seemed as a very cheap and nasty thing in days gone by, but now when it is a 'whole', the thing is solid and doesn't fall apart, break or look silly. Maybe the kids of today do know a thing or two.

Speaking of knowing a thing or two, this new toy of mine has made me think a little differently about Norton's new top end machines. It is little secret that TVS of India has purchased the brand. They have built a fancy new expensive factory complex at Solihull in the British Midlands and have completely re-engineered the 1200 cc Vee 4 motor, now built in India and shipped to the UK to be bolted into the chassis. This is known as 'Globalization'. The result is a very fancy looking piece of kit, available in two guises. The flagship Manx R is all head-down-bum-up, whilst the Manx is a naked, with an upright seating position. Both have the same motor, a Vee4 that emits 206 HP and 130 ft/lb of torque produced at a lowly 7,000 rpm. My new bike develops 152hp at the rear wheel and has 82 ft/lb of torque at about 8,000 rpm. It is a rocket-ship as far as I am concerned and will need some serious mental control not to see me on the wrong side of the law. This Norton, on paper, makes my bike look very tame by comparison. Here is the difference that Norton has identified and pursued. They are not really competing with the Continental and Oriental machinery that now are producing somewhere around 220 to 230 HP and are sprouting wings like Airbus on steroids, they have aimed their products at real world riders who wish for performance but are not really interested in track days or escaping their knee sliders at every roundabout.

Riding in today's world of ultra correctness sees little opportunity to use 200+ hp on the roads unless one is on a German Autobahn, but low to mid-range torque is there to play with constantly, and that is the thing that can give one the 'Jollys' all day long. To my way of thinking the upright, naked would be the more usable bike, but the advent of an 80th birthday may have coloured that judgement. Sadly, the two bikes are going to be a little hamstrung by an eye watering price tag and the lack of a worldwide dealer network. Quite like one in my shed tho'.....

Going back in time a year or so, 78 years to be precise, when Triumph produced this 1948 Triumph Speed Twin we see on the front cover of this issue, it is as if time had stood still and the bike had just rolled off the assembly line in Meriden. Restoring a bike of this age is not an easy task and it is obvious that it has had some serious love (money) lavished upon it in returning the bike to its former glory. The owner, Ken Miles, has done a very good job in the restoration of the bike to get it to its current state and it runs as sweetly as it looks, attracting many admiring examinations from the assembled members.

By the time this is in your hands one of our sister clubs will be taking its final breath as it lies in its deathbed. The Waikato Classic Motorcycle club has been struggling on in recent years with dwindling membership as the few stalwarts have valiantly tried to keep things together. Sadly, for them it has got to 'wind-up Time' and they are in the final stages of doing so. Their club funds will be distributed to various charities, a final farewell meal and it will be but a fond memory. It is not our place to venture as to why, indeed there are many factors as to why a club such as theirs becomes no more, but the march of time as the population's values and interests move on is probably a big factor.

We are fortunate with our set-up, a good mix of old and new bikes, a welcoming club rooms that is indeed a popular gathering place in both winter and summer and a membership that is enthusiastic about most aspects of motorcycling. We are also blessed with a good assortment of secondary roads that afford us the opportunity to spend many happy miles/kilometres swinging our way to various venues. We should not become too casual about what we have, as with all clubs of our nature the average age of members tends to increase and with this the activities we plan and organise need to take this into consideration. The low numbers of our members who fully participate in our annual rally tell us something, and I'm sure the committee is aware of this. So, what could we do?

The rising costs of everything means we need to think of clever ways to attract and involve all. A day event such as the Mail Run is a great example of how a day can be spent without costing the earth. Could we expand on the Blue Smoke and Pedals theme and hold a gymkhana that is suitable for all bikes, a club BBQ lunch, or invite a food truck to supply our midday eats, followed by a meal at the local RSA to cap the day off? We could hold the most interesting bottle opener competition. Gumboot throwing was always popular in Taihape until the fun police decided we were endangering the lives of some unknown individual; we could institute a clutch plate frisbee event. There are many things that we could maybe do. Let's all think....

August means many things; it is the end of Winter; it is also the month of the Manx GP on the fabled Isle of Man. This year has seen a team of three Kiwi bikes make the pilgrimage. Peter Lodge with his incredible ES2 based Norton single; Richard Hiscock who is now the owner of the ex. Dave Kenah 500cc Manx, itself no stranger to the Island and completing the trifecta is a swath of Velocettes lead by Phil Price.

The schedule for the races was shuffled around due to weather issues, but Mike Brown on Peter Lodge's ES2 took third place behind two Patton DOHC twins, a remarkable result for a pushrod two valve single. Peter has now finished on the podium three times from four visits, a win being the result from 2025. "Well done that man".

Dave Johnson, riding Richard's Manx, crashed at Glen Helen and sustained a broken leg and the Velo retired with a gearbox that cried "Nuff". Our congratulations to all involved with Team Kiwi Classic TT 2026, you guys probably don't know how many smiles on faces here you engender, thank you, thank you, thank you.

Mike

LETTER FROM AMERICA

We welcome life member Russell Riddell to our pages. Russell is domiciled in Texas and has offered to give us a glimpse of motorcycling Stateside from his perspective. Many years ago, Russell was instrumental in securing our clubrooms. We thank him every weekend.



This story begins back in the 70's, most likely in 1975. I was a 16 y.o. schoolboy with a 1958 Austin Cambridge. My "ride" was a 1965 Jawa 175 on which I had bent the conrod. At the time there was a car/bike dealer in Napier, whose name I forget now, who sold CZ/Jawa parts. (On Taradale Rd.) While buying a new conrod, which was complete with big-end and bearing, it cost \$27.50. I remember that! I looked at a nearly new Triumph TR5T Adventurer. Then I took a test ride. After the Jawa it was a revelation...!!! Smooth, fast, cool.... I wanted it badly. The dealer offered me \$500 trade on my Cambridge and the bike was \$1200 so I needed to come up with \$700. This I couldn't find so the dream faded on the vine. For a while anyway.....

Leap forward to about 1983 and Barry Lay had been to a swap meet in Palmerston North and bought an imported American version of the Adventurer which they called "Trophy Trail". Same bike, different name. The dream came alive and I bought the bike from Barry. I used it as my classic bike occasionally. By then I had ridden a few bikes and by the time I owned the bike I now realized it was still smooth, still cool, but definitely not fast.

A memorable trip on the Triumph was our mid 80's classic club run to Rotorua's annual Classic Rally. (You know the one where Jim made close friends with the Rotorua crowd. I believe we are still friends with them to this day. Despite the slightly rocky beginning...) Another memorable part of this trip was that we thought the Luge would be a good use of our motorcycling skills. Bruce Hemmingway promptly broke his arm. Now he had ridden a new Harley EVO FXR to the rally and had no easy way to get it home. So, he asked me to ride it back. The, not so fast, Triumph was promptly relegated to the club trailer, and I rode his EVO home. It was a great trip. Sometime later I sold the bike to Wayne Howell down in Takapau. Nice bike, but the dream was superseded by other bikes.

Leap forward again to 1991. I was moving to American Samoa and wanted a good, reliable bike to use for work transport. I spoke to Wayne and bought the bike back. It was exported to Samoa and for 4 years there it was my daily ride. A 11 mile round trip, 22 miles every day. It never let me down once.

After Samoa I moved to Ghana, West Africa. There I had a company vehicle so only rode the Triumph occasionally and again it was superseded by a magnificent Honda XR600R. That bike was a monster. Loved it. The Triumph languished.

Now we leap forward to the year 2000. I moved to Paris, France. The Triumph and the Honda moved with me. As I had an apartment on the Seine without a garage or

storage, I was pressed for space in that tiny abode. Something had to go. I reluctantly sold the XR600 because the Triumph was still sentimentally part of my early dreams. I still miss that XR though. It sure had grunt along the Ghanian beaches and thru their savannah bush plains. Many a ride there.



Just a year later, 2001, I left Paris for the U.S of A... The Triumph came with me.

And that my friends is where the Triumph has languished.

Twenty-five years sitting in my workshop. Nearly forgotten. A relic of my youthful dreams.

Never ridden once. Never cleaned. Not unloved, just neglected. Moved from corner to corner to make way for another

project or three..... UNTIL today, (9 September in the year of our Lord,)

I looked at it today and fondly remembered the good times. I remembered the above memories. It deserves a better fate. So, the work begins. New tyres were ordered tonight. Thoughts of a plan to resurrect it are churning thru what's left of my brain.

The dream is not yet over. May we all live long enough to see the end notes.

Laterrrrr,

Russell

WOTS ON AROUND HERE

OCTOBER	NOVEMBER	DECEMBER
Saturday 3rd Kickstart & Retro	Saturday 7th Kickstart & Retro	Saturday 5th Kickstart & Retro
Saturday 10th Club open	Wednesday 11th Retirees Ride	Wednesday 9th Retirees Ride
Wednesday 14th Retirees Ride	Saturday 14th Club open	Saturday 12th Classic Ride
Saturday 17th Classic Ride	Saturday 21st Classic Ride	Saturday 19th End of year Ride
Saturday 24th Limerick reading Club open	Saturday 28th End of Month Ride	Saturday 26th Xmas shut down
Saturday 31st End of month Ride		

IT'S AUGUST, ITS COLD, AND WE ARE GOING FOR A RIDE

Yes the above adjective of 'cold', was well to the fore as a brave bunch turned up for the August kickstart, Retro, Little two-pops, Scooters, all were in attendance, as were a couple of renegades aboard bikes that fitted none of the advertised criteria, but they were there and welcomed. 'You meet the nicest people at a Classic Club' Some lively banter ensued as your editor was taken to task for selling his "Never to be sold Norton, by a stuttering and spluttering Bantam rider, who was threatening many dastardly deeds for such a callous act. People were frantically cuddling one-another to keep warm, at least that is what was being touted as the raison d'être by those who did.....

Setting off into weather that was threatening precipitation we proceeded at a somewhat leisurely pace to twist and turn our way toward the Esk Valley. The roads were mostly dry, not always tho' so one needed not to go to sleep. I noticed a bit of a vague feeling on the front as we wandered along some stretches, the return along the same roads revealed a fair smattering of loose gravel in places which maybe accounted for such. On returning home and checking the front tyre pressure I found it was well down. Sorry regional council, it was probably me at fault. It turns out my fancy portable tyre inflator, when being disconnected, manages to lose about 3-4psi. Another project is looming, I fear.



The heated grips and handguards were working well on my non-compliant bike and tho' it was struggling to be anything else but cold, conditions were not too bad, things then suddenly got worse as winter in the form of rain and wind arrived as we passed Roy's Hill heading toward the vision of 'Stoker Murfit's' warm fire in the clubrooms. This onslaught was most uncalled for and saw a well dampened bunch head for the Pot-bellied warming device as soon as they dismounted, your Editor being amongst them. The clubrooms were buzzing, as very few elected to remain outside and in short order Nick the barman of the day was kept well occupied as he dealt to the re-hydration requirements of the masses.

The Bodger was distributed, complete with Rally entry forms and then a welcome pot of Cherrios and plates of buttered bread arrived. A semi-orderly scrum ensued as the warm fare was devoured. It really was a nice place to be on a cold afternoon.

Our thanks go to Roger Gray who has taken over the mantle of organising the Kickstart rides, also to our Barman of the day Nick, plus the many washer-uppers and tidy-uppers who tend to our well-being. It's a great little club we have here, the people make it so.

Mike

A JOURNEY INTO THE FUTURE. TIME TRAVEL FOR OUR MEMBERS

For many years our club has scratched its head as to how the future may look for members as time rolls by. The Retirees run, a wonderful monthly event, has opened our eyes to many things that happen here in our area of the world that were unknown to most of us. So, it happened once more, when in August, on a rather overcast day, we were shown what the future could hold for many of us.

Taking over the unofficial reigns from our recently departed Eric McDougall, Dave Christie set out to remove some of the mystery that awaits us by taking us to Duart House, an elder care facility, where we got to see a glimpse of what may lie ahead. It is fair to say that this is not what most of us are looking forward to as we actively assume Ostrich-like activity by burying our heads in sand, with our butts in the air and hoping the rest of the world is 'straight' as we place our trust in the great unknown.

Leaving the tongue -in-cheek future behind there was a good turnout with a big variety of bikes on display ranging from the giant GS BMW, some somewhat well used off roaders displaying their badges of right in the form of mud and dirt, a range of British iron and of course the wonderful world of Japan with their endless variety of normal road bikes, Jim was there with his WWII Indian and Grant was holding up the two-stroke brigade with his thirsty little triple. Let's not forget the self-standing three-wheeler that John Sheriden had all talking about. Following it, one was convinced he was dragging both feet on the ground, but no, "It's just the front wheels Sir".

As we wound our way up the narrow driveway to the Havelock North Club to partake of 'High Tea' after chatting to the 'Guys and Dolls' and examining their swollen ankles and arthritic fingers, it was obvious that those of us riding the off roaders had made the right choice, the potholes were magnificent in their number and placement. I guess it discourages the use of those pesky scooters. We chatted, we made valiant attempts at washing away the visions of our possible future with the array of beverage available, we ate the French-Fries so thoughtfully provided and then we made our way to our places of comfort having dodged the semi-predicted rain.

Thankyou Merv and Dave, for organising the day it was nice to chat to the residents at Duart, I enjoyed joshing and offering rides to the 'young women', hopefully we might have made their day interesting for them. Who knows, it may be us with our walkers shuffling out to see the next visit by a bunch of motorcyclists, looking at things from the other side of life. We know not what the future holds for us, but we have been given a glimpse.....

Mike

The most reliable way to predict the future is to create it

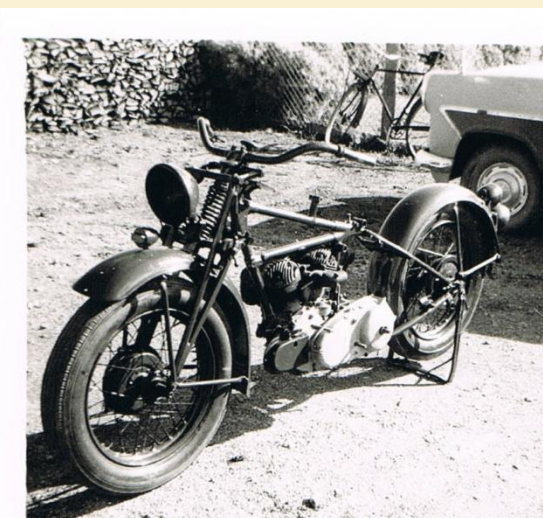
Abraham Lincoln

My 741 Army Indian

By Jim Lord (with a few words from Sam)

You have all seen my Indian Model 741 as it has been around the Club since about 1980. With its original 500cc engine and all of about 5HP, it has done trips to Rotorua, Waikaremoana, Ringo Starr rides (back when the road was gravel), and monthly club rides in all weather. In those early years I was working seven days a week during the summer and 5.5 days a week in the winter getting our first service station business off the ground. This left little to no time for riding my Indian, but when I did, I enjoyed it!

I've owned the bike since about 1968, when my uncle gave it to me in a disassembled state. He had bought the bike and removed the engine and gearbox to power a home-built farm buggy on his sheep station, in the style of what later would be four-wheel farm bikes. It took until the mid-1970s to get it restored, painted, and registered, and it has been used consistently ever since by me, Sam, and several club



members on Mail Run duty, Art Deco, and ANZAC parades.

Over the years a few things have caused the ride of shame — battery issues, a broken crank pin, the head breaking off an inlet valve, broken cables, and flat tyres — but for the mileage done, not too bad. The bike has also tried to and successfully tossed me off on a couple of occasions, and because of the relatively low speeds the consequences have always been limited to bruises,

embarrassment, and good stories at the clubrooms. Every dent and scratch has its own story.

A 741 is not a fast bike, but is a forgiving one, and that is exactly why it is so rewarding. And because the limits are modest, you can actually ride it at its limit. That is something we rarely experience on modern bikes, where the performance is so high that the rider never truly reaches the edge of what the machine can do.

On the 741, the limit is accessible, understandable, and confidence-inspiring. You feel the bike working with you. You sense every bump the road has bobbing up and down on the saddle seat. You learn to be smooth, braking only when necessary and carrying as much speed as you can everywhere especially up hills! Sam also grew up watching me ride the 741 and learned to ride it in 2005. He learned to ride up and down Palomino Road, then immediately began stretching the bike's legs: Tukituki loops, and

Patangata loops down Middle Road. By 2006 he was riding gravel on Glengarry Road and Puketitiri Road, earned Youngest Rider at the rally, and keeping pace with other classic bikes on club runs. Some of our best memories come from those years*: frozen helmets on the Taihape Road in 2008, puddles and torrential rain in Haast, the 741 fortuitously running out of fuel in the driveway at the end of a club run, and New Year's Eve rides where we could have five Indians out.

My Indian received an engine upgrade to 600cc after purchasing the late Bill Owens 600cc 741, before he passed, that Sam now predominately rides. Now with two 600cc Indians – one for me and one for Sam, it makes for some fun riding together

In the South Island, the Hakataramea Pass and Molesworth Station rate right up there for great Indian rides, with gravel sections, water fords, gates, and cattle stops to negotiate. In the North Island, it was the first motorcycle to do the overnight trip to the back of Lochinver Station on the Rangitaiki Plains with friends in the VCC – another great ride.

One moment Sam and I will never forget was in 2008, having ridden from Reefton through to Westport down the coast on both 741 and 841 Indians on a glorious summer's day. We pulled into Greymouth's main street exactly as the clock in the centre of town chimed 6pm right in front of us!

I know that everybody who has ridden my 741 comes back smiling, albeit nervous smiles to start with. It is a bike that teaches you something. It rewards effort and it is still very much regularly ridden. Next year's Mail Run – Taupo to Napier – is the perfect chance for more members to experience what a 741 feels like. If you've ever wanted to try a hand-shift, foot-clutch, left-hand throttle Indian, or simply want a story



worth telling, come talk to me. Classic bikes are meant to be ridden, and I'm always happy to share it, I've got a few!

Sam kept detailed riding notes from 2005-2013 of every

Indian ride and averaged about ~1000km a year on my original 741 when it was 500cc.

Jim, Maggie and Sam

We are saddened to learn of the passing of a well-known and admired man Dave Whitaker, late of Dave Whitaker Honda. Dave had very generously supported our club over many years with prizes etc for our activities. We offer our sincere condolences to his family and friends

Remembering those who have left us

A rather gloomy day in mid-August saw 10 brave souls arrive at Clive for the club's Memorial Ride this year. An early casualty saw Bantam loving Jim's Triumph lose the will to run as the battery decided that it just didn't have enough oomph to light the fire required at the off a quick swap with a yellow Suzuki saw him arrive back at the clubrooms a little earlier than expected after the ride.

A little further down the road and it was Mike Steel who came to an unplanned halt, a 20% fatality rate and they had hardly got going! Fortunately, the remaining 8 made it back to the club looking as if they had dodged the forecast rain, which had not really eventuated. The rest of us consoled ourselves by telling tall stories and keeping Mark behind the bar occupied. Jim Lord on his faithful Indian took away the prize of the day to add to its impressive list of accolades.



The day was not quite over as Murphy arrived to torment Matt O'Sullivan's Kawasaki, as its throttle cable decided not to remain as designed and became less than whole. This resulted in his bike having a sleep in the clubrooms overnight whilst a plan was being hatched to perform yet a further resurrection, having just got it mobile again after a slight miscalculation involving

gravity some weeks earlier. 'Stoker Murfitt' had ensured that all were cozy in the club rooms as we stood for a moment remembering those who had left us over the years.

Mike



A strange thing happened recently in the Editorial shed one night. I came out to find that a birth had taken place and a mini-me MT10 SP had arrived on the garage floor. I guess this all started in the Isle of South in a corner of the FILCO workshop which didn't recognise the signs of my bike being on heat!! I will speak to a well-known LEGO collector who has been known to covert these sorts of things.

Thanks Mark

POETIC JUSTICE

The current bout of cold weather has confined many to the warmth of their fireside's/heat pumps. Some may doze the hours away, some may read books, others may attempt to replace the dead battery in their cordless razor, many indoor pursuits are being undertaken. Allow me to add to the list of things to exercise your grey matter.

Why don't we have a limerick competition? We all know at least one or two of these little rhymes. The Hawke's Bay anniversary weekend would seem to be an ideal time to have a public 'Reading' of our efforts on Saturday 24th. The winner would be by acclaim from the assembled masses; prizes may be as generous as a Whitaker's peanut slab. Have a go, you may surprise yourself. Using Editorial privilege, I have proclaimed October 24th as the day of reading

FOR SALE

This rather tasty 1960 G12 Matchless is for sale. Several years ago, the bike was fully rebuilt, the story of this may be seen on the New Zealand Jampot club website. Fitted with the later Nodular Iron Crankshaft, it is a great bike for touring. Contact Don Thomson for details ph. 027 443 8330.



SADLY, WE LOST ONE OF OUR WORLD CLASS RACERS RECENTLY.
'GINGER' MALLOY RACED IN EUROPE IN THE LATE '60'S AND EARLY
'70'S, FINISHING RUNNER UP TO AGOSTINI IN THE WORLD
CHAMPIONSHIPS IN 1970. IN RECENT YEARS WE SAW HIM COMPETING
ON HIS BULTACOS AT MANY CLASSIC EVENTS IN OUR COUNTRY. OUR
CONDOLENCES TO HIS FAMILY AND FRIENDS, RIP GINGER

IS THERE A COUNTRY HOTEL IN THE DEPTHS OF CROWNTHORPE?

Once your club was tasked with searching the by-ways, driveways and dead-end roads to try to find out if this, by now, mythical object did in fact exist. This was no easy undertaking as the powers that be had set traps along the way to stop this constant search. This time they sprinkled loose gravel over the roading to focus our attention on what we were riding on, rather than what we may have been riding past. What a fiendish trick and this was on top of covering other sections with lichen, plus sprinkling us with rain as we searched. Fortunately, the donning of wet weather gear by Ray Jenkins was enough to stop this last drama. It is a well-known fact that if one stops to adorn oneself with wet weather gear the rain will immediately stop!!!

A large contingent of bikes and riders assembled at Clive, were briefed by Grant and sent off to find the Napier-Taihapa Road and head up it until we reached the Otamauri Playcenter where we would stop before 'playing' in the depths of Crownthorpe. Full of enthusiasm for the hunt the region became swamped with the roar of bikes as the many twists, turns, humps and hollows of the area were traversed. The game that was unannounced was looking out for the road repairs with loose metal covering the road surface, "All part of country living Sir!

As we emerged back onto the Napier/Taihapa Road I managed to provide some 'entertainment' by giving a display of bumble-footed stop-go-stop, as I avoided a collision with a car that "just appeared". Fortunately, it came to nought.

The collective sigh of despair when no pub was found, saw all return to the clubrooms where Debbie was tending our re-hydration needs and the highly skilled sausage turners and onion cooks were once more displaying their talents on the BBQ.

So, it was a spring day, warmish, grayish, with a hint of precipitation that saw the realisation that maybe there is not a pub tucked away in the folds of Crownthorpe's valleys, but it would be a great place to find one.....

One of the highlights of the day was standing around admiring our President's new bike. Adelle had decided she needed some excitement of the two wheeled variety, something that her Trusty Triumph was no longer providing, so she has gone all Oriental and now can be seen on a CF Moto 675 NK, a naked, triple cylindered lump of fun. The shed at 'Singerville' is now seriously bursting at the seams – so what, if it makes you smile it must be good for you, enjoy, enjoy.....

Thanks to Grant, Matthew, Debbie and Roger and his team of cookie monsters, not forgetting all the others who make this club fun to belong to.

Mike

To help one to remember the names of the North American Great Lakes, the mnemonic "SHOWME" was created. Now it is even easier since Trump just changed Lake Ontario to Lake America, the new mnemonic is.....

"SHAME"!

MARSHALLING THE TROOPS

Hawke's Bay, the land of eternal sunshine once more lived up to this hopeful descriptor, well until Sunday! It's early Spring, the days are slowly deciding that it is time to get warm and as the sun made an appearance the cold-blooded ones slowly came to life. This year I had decided that my own bed was a preferable place of repose and as the dulcet tones of my alarm jarred me into conscious thought the normal awakening activities were dispensed with and at a rather early time, I was on the big Yammie and heading out to Stony Creek to see what Grant, our fearless Four Star General, had in store for me. Yes, I had put my hand up to be a Ride Marshall for our rally. Sorting through the box of hi-vis vests soon had me looking like a giant orange pumpkin and I joined the other pumpkins as we sorted who would be where, as we were attempting to avoid another ride of the "Lost Boys", a rather too prevalent activity of our club rides.

A rally is all about catching up with friends, telling the embarrassing stories about oneself and listening to theirs, this day was no different and it was great. The 'Call to Arms' went out and with the press of a button I was away to stand on a roundabout and wave my arms in the general direction that all should head. This seemed to be working out rather well and as we gathered at the first re-group stop it was obvious that the venue was now two venues.

Dickie Waterer and I had been allotted to stand on the side of the road just before the Pourere Beach destination to alert our guests that the road surface was not of Autobahn standard and be careful as they proceeded. I gave up waiting for the back-up vehicle and joined the great beach feast at the far end of the road where a couple of Honda tents had been erected and the multitude were all sitting around eating a rather tasty box lunch. The back up vehicle finally arrived with Basil Craig's Triumph sitting on the trailer of shame. It turned out that Mr. Back-up had gone to the wrong beach!!! I guess it preserves the "Lost Boys" legend.

Having filled our bellies, it was time to now fill our steeds and for this we bounced our way into Waipawa and kept the staff at the local BP busy as they sold lots of small amounts of petrol to many people. The final section was once more an opportunity to demonstrate that Hawke's Bay's secondary roads are crying out for some serious and expensive remedial work. I have no idea how the future generations will cope as more and more AI Robots will be doing everything, and as they are machines and as such will be unpaid, so no tax dollars will be coming into the public coffers. Maybe the idea of drone transport does have some merit???

Where are the pictures from our gathering? I hear you ask. The answer my friend is blowing in the wind, or certainly in the 'Cloud'. The club Facebook page has all and many and it is rather pointless for me to duplicate them here. Suffice to say we are indebted to those who post their images for all to see.

Events such as these don't just fall out of the sky, there is a lot of volunteer work that goes into the organising and running of the weekend, for this we are very thankful and grateful to the Club officials and the many on the day who perform these tasks for our benefit.

Well done all of you

Mike

InterIslander & Bluebridge ferry discounts

Our club belongs to the NZ Federation of Motoring Clubs Inc. This enables club members to access to cheap, cheap, cheap , discounted ferry fares between the South and North Islands—better than the AA discount or the Gold Card discount. Here's the deal (and it does not matter what type of vehicle you take) - it applies to both ferry companies.

The special fare discounts apply to both the Interislander and Bluebridge ferries. To make a booking, click here: <https://www.cookstraitcrossings.co.nz/>

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The new owner, Kerry Good, of the above business has very generously offered a 20% discount on listed prices to our club members, simply quote 'HBCMC' with your order to receive this. He has also donated a large bunch of prizes for our rally.

Let's support him

Maurice Frederick Heaps

7 October 1960 - 27 August 2026

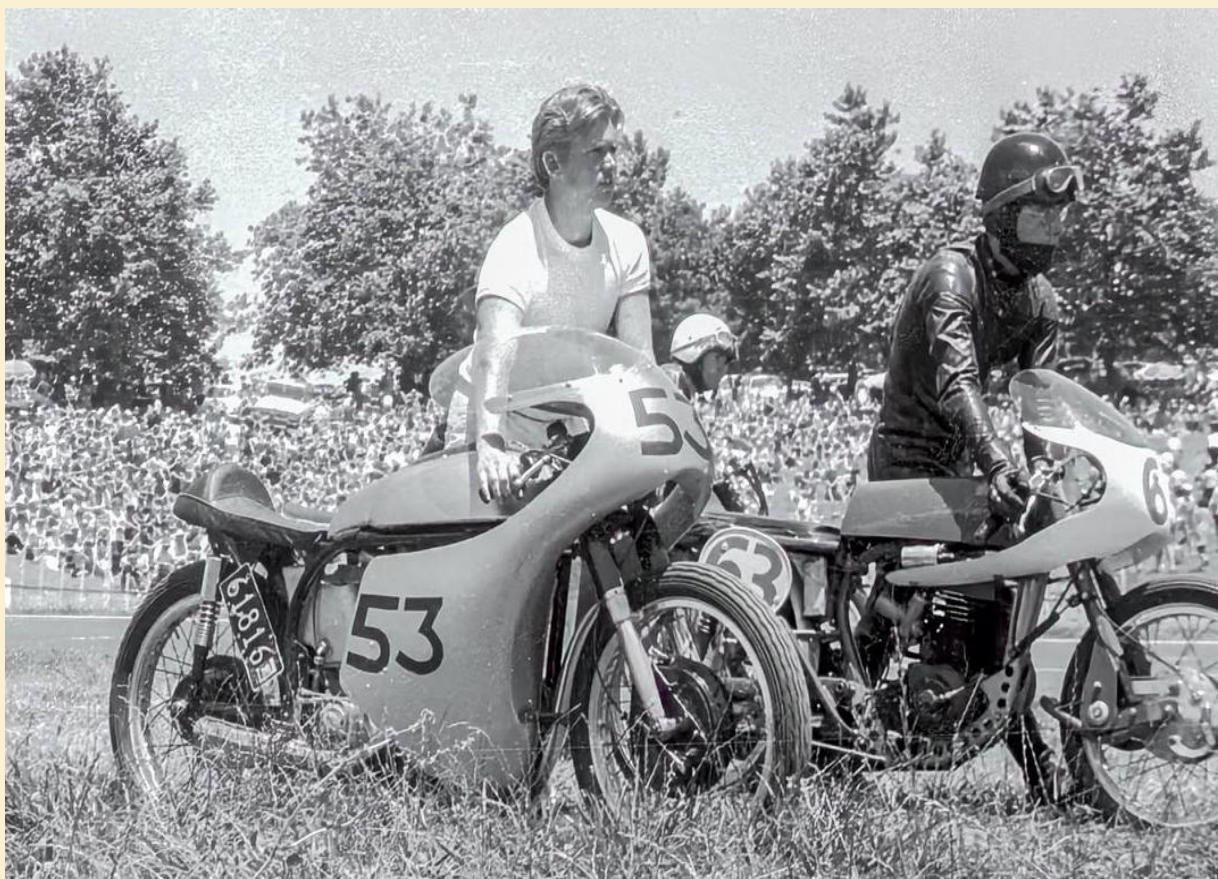


Our club sadly lost Life Member Maurice Heaps on the 27th August after his battle with cancer. Maurice was very generous toward the club in days gone by with renovations and general upkeep of our rooms. I well remember his fronting up on a Triumph Rocket Three a few years ago, a big chap on a big bike, they suited each other well.

We offer our sincere condolences to his family and loved ones

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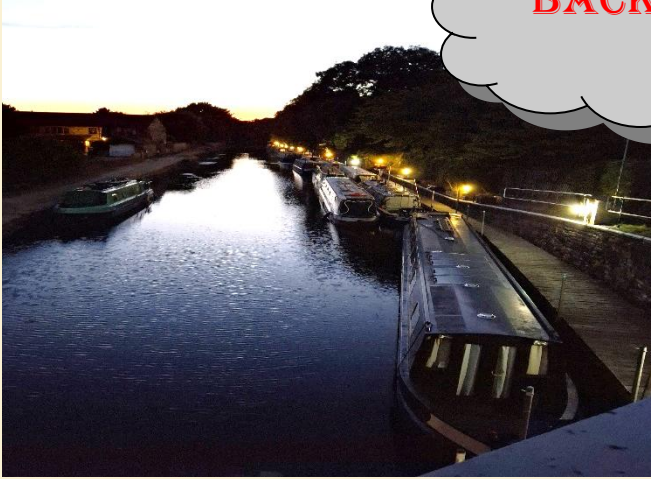


From Pukekohe 1968 I wonder who No. 63 is???? The photo below may offer a clue.



1918 and it has swing arm rear suspension, electric lighting when the rest of the world was still playing around with a rigid rear end and acetylene gas. Jim Lord's Indian Power Plus, 1000 cc vee twin was given an outing to help celebrate Jim's birthday. We all enjoyed the occasion.

BACKFIRE



George and Trish's motorcycling trip around the UK has taken an unexpected turn, as water, currently a rare commodity in Europe, has crept into their lives. They have 'Narrowly' avoided getting wet so far, although the pubs along the canals are a slight distraction.

Below we see the new 'baby' in the Singer household. All very new and nicely put together thank you. Triplets are becoming rather common in their shed these days! Welcome 'Nikky'. No it's not yellow, but there wasn't a grey one there either



Another masterpiece from the workshop of John Mossey Classics in the UK. I don't care if it is a slow old thing, it just looks gorgeous